

Bihar Museum in Patna

LIVING ARCHIVE

6 THE MUSEUM MOMENT

New Delhi is fast becoming a city of art museums. All eyes are already on the massive, state-of-the-art Kiran Nadar Museum of Art (KNMA) coming up near New Delhi's Aerocity, touted as India's largest private museum. The city, which already has single-artist museums on Amarnath Sehgal and Arpana Caur, is now readying for Sunil Munjal's The Brij. Then there is the biggie: the Ministry of Culture's Yuge Yugeen Bharat Museum. The under-construction national museum, spread across 1.55 lakh square metres, could become the world's largest museum when fully completed. But the boom is not confined to the capital. Bengaluru's MAP [The Museum of Art & Photography] has much going for it. The one that's got everybody really talking, though, is the Bihar Museum in Patna—a government museum that is world-class architecturally as well as for its programming.

THE ART IDIOM

7 THE SCULPTURAL TURN

Once considered the poor cousin of painting, sculpture is enjoying its own moment. And while modern sculpture has considerable pedigree, from Ramkinkar Baij in Bengal to Pilloo Pochkhanawala in Bombay and Dhanraj Bhagat in Delhi, today's sculptors are increasingly working as installation artists, expanding our understanding of what sculpture can be.



Partha Dasgupta's *The Viewers*, presented by Art Alive Gallery in New Delhi